

INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE LT02

Unit 2 Place in literary texts

Mark scheme

January 2025

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2 5 1 X L T 0 2 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Assessment Writer.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

1. All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
2. Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
3. Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
4. Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
5. Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
6. Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
7. If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

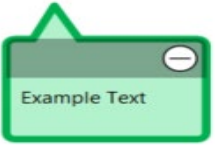
Using the mark bands

8. When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6–8. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

9. Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
10. There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
11. Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Incorrect		Toolbar Tooltip: Incorrect		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text – text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

12. All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills halfway through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	• Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	• Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. • Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	• Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	• Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. • Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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Joseph Conrad: *Heart of Darkness*

‘*Heart of Darkness* expresses despair on behalf of Africa and its people.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Heart of Darkness* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the narrator’s possibly despairing response to colonial exploitation: eg as seen in the condition of the forced labourers at the Central Station
- the attitudes of Europeans who see Africa only as a resource: eg manager of Central Station, Eldorado Exploring Expedition, pilgrims
- the malign influence of Kurtz on African people
- the land itself despoiled in places, elephants killed for ivory
- Marlow not despairing: eg ‘remote kinship with African people’, rescue of Kurtz not being worth the loss of The Helmsman’s life, Africa ‘monstrous and free’
- some hope shown: eg African people fight back, ‘wild-eyed and magnificent woman’ confronts Kurtz’s rescuers.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Marlow’s narrative point of view and ambiguity in his attitudes
- darkness as motif and the narrative structure of a journey to its heart
- racist language
- attitudes other than Marlow’s presented through characters, dialogue and action
- frame narrative set in London with audience representative of colonial attitudes
- lexical choices and figurative language in descriptions of Africans and Europeans.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	2
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F. Scott Fitzgerald: *The Great Gatsby*

‘Who you are, not what you own, matters most in 1920s America as presented by Fitzgerald.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Great Gatsby* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- a class system that privileges the Buchanans because of their background
- how Gatsby is of lower status than East Eggers despite his material wealth
- the illusory promise of the American Dream
- Myrtle Wilson’s inability to escape the valley of ashes
- how criminal behaviour does facilitate some social mobility
- the underlying moral values that Fitzgerald presents.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the tragic pattern as shown in the fate of Gatsby and Myrtle Wilson as aspirational characters
- the use of characters to present opposing values: eg Daisy Buchanan escapes the law, Gatsby and Nick Carraway show personal and ethical values
- Nick Carraway’s role as a retrospective narrator with a bias in favour of the protagonist
- lexical choices and figurative language: eg to convey material opulence or convey personal values
- symbolism for material wealth or poverty: eg cars, houses, valley of ashes
- the use of dialogue to convey conflicting values.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	3
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Kazuo Ishiguro: *The Remains of the Day*

To what extent do you agree that English society is presented negatively in *The Remains of the Day*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Remains of the Day* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the life of Darlington Hall structured strictly on social class lines
- a household working efficiently, but at the expense of closer, more caring relationships
- the role of the aristocracy in English life in the 1930s: eg 'great gentlemen' making 'mighty decisions'
- Lord Darlington regarding democracy as outmoded and collaborating with Nazi Germany, but condemned by wider society
- society outside Darlington Hall in 1950s being more open, less hidebound
- fascism and antisemitism in the inter-war period.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- a chronological narrative employing Stevens' narrow, biased perspective to present a critical viewpoint
- Darlington Hall as a setting that reflects aspects of the English class system
- the use of Stevens' journey to the West Country to give a broader view of society
- the use of characters such as M Dupont and Mr Lewis to give views of the political situation
- how the Stevens-Miss Kenton narrative presents aspects of social attitudes
- dialogue, lexical choices, figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	4
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Aravind Adiga: *Last Man in Tower*

Explore the narrative significance of the title of *Last Man in Tower*.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Last Man in Tower* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the intensely close relationship between Masterji and his home
- how to some, Dharmen Shah in particular, Tower A is just a building
- the gradual changes in the attitudes of the residents who successively give up their homes
- how the title offers an outline of the narrative
- the rooftop of the tower as the murder scene, and the death fall from it
- Masterji's role as protagonist and hero, or anti-hero in his resistance to progress.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- a chronological, episodic narrative that climaxes with Masterji being thrown from the tower
- the division into nine books with topic headings and/or dated chapters to support the narrative
- the use of characters to show differing and changing attitudes towards leaving Tower A
- the use of dialogue to show attitudes towards Masterji and his determination to stay
- Tower A as a metonym for a variety of attitudes: eg as a place of cooperation, a home, a potential development, a source of money, a place to be defended
- language features: eg lexical choices and figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	5
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Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: *Americanah*

‘Adichie’s narrative challenges the belief that America is the land of the free.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Americanah* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- racism as a pervasive attitude: eg Ifemelu’s experiences, Obama’s election but hatred in posts about him
- social and economic inequality, as experienced by immigrants and American blacks
- patriarchy in American society: eg Ifemelu being ‘Curt’s girlfriend’, Blaine’s expectations of her
- a place that allows some immigration and offers opportunities
- Ifemelu’s eventual success both educationally and economically, or/and her being able to rediscover her Nigerian identity
- how it is necessary to conform and accept some restrictions to be accepted and have success.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the narrative structure in which the story returns at intervals to the braiding salon where Ifemelu is preparing to leave America
- Ifemelu’s role as narrator to convey her personal experiences as well as those of Uju and Dike
- hair: eg braiding and relaxing in relation to social and economic pressures
- Ifemelu’s blog as record of social attitudes and problems: eg ‘oppression olympics’
- locations that imply social segregation: eg Trenton and Princeton
- dialogue: eg first with Cristina Tomas and then with Ginika concerning accents
- lexical choices, figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	6
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Andrea Levy: *Small Island*

‘Jamaica gives, England takes and then rejects.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the relationship between the two countries as presented in *Small Island*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Small Island* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- how the Jamaican contribution to the war effort is not appreciated even at the time
- how Hortense is educated in colonial values only to find she cannot be a teacher in England
- the colonial deception of England as the mother country
- how Gilbert, an ex-serviceman in need of work, becomes a Windrush passenger
- how Queenie quickly befriends Gilbert when he is in the RAF and provides lodgings for him and Hortense after the war
- Gilbert’s job interviews and his experiences of working for the Post Office
- how Hortense and Gilbert eventually find a home of their own.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of Before and 1948 sections to juxtapose pre and post-war
- the use of Gilbert’s experiences in the RAF to show both exploitation and rejection
- how different narrative voices present different attitudes and points of view
- the use of humour to show Jamaican tolerance
- how the bleak settings of post-war present London as unwelcoming, as well as the characterisation of Bernard Bligh and Mr Todd
- the narrative of the affair between Queenie and Michael Roberts
- racist expressions: eg ‘you people’, ‘your sort’.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0 7

Thomas Hardy poetry selection

‘Hardy presents nature as being entirely separate from the life of the individual.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘Places’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Hardy's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- how the locations in ‘Places’ do not prompt recollections of the woman except in the memory of the speaker
- the bird in ‘The Darkling Thrush’ not reflecting the speaker’s mood, but other aspects of the setting being in keeping with it
- the extent to which nature is significant
- the relationship between natural features and grief: eg ‘Beeny Cliff’, ‘At Castle Boterel’, ‘The Going’
- individual experiences: eg in ‘The Oxen’, ‘The Self Unseeing’
- how unhappiness or loss may be reflected by other aspects of place than just natural features.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the structural use of ‘Nobody’ in the given poem followed by ‘Nay’ in the closing stanza
- the use of first person and personal address
- the ways in which ideas are ordered and developed
- the use of locations with or without natural features
- the structural use of stanza form, rhyme and other types of prosody
- lexical choices, figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	8
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William Wordsworth poetry selection

‘There is more to Wordsworth’s poetry than respect for the environment.’

To what extent do you agree? You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.
[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Wordsworth's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- consideration of the implications of ‘respect’ and other attitudes suggested by the given view
- the visual splendour of ‘Composed Upon Westminster Bridge’, or Yarrow not being visited
- environmental concern in ‘Nutting’ perhaps with attention to guilty feelings
- going beyond respect: eg ‘worshipper of Nature’
- the human tragedy in ‘Michael’
- moral or personal concerns: eg ‘A Narrow Girdle of Rough Stones and Crags’, ‘Elegiac Stanzas’.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrative structure in the presentation of personal experience: eg the different stages in ‘Nutting’
- the narrative structure of ‘Michael’
- structural features in the development of complex or spiritual ideas
- different points of view: eg in relation to nature, to an addressee within the poem, to the reader
- lexical choices, figurative language
- versification: eg stanza forms, metre, rhyme.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the poems should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0 9

Robert Frost poetry selection

‘Frost’s places usually reflect the speaker’s unhappiness.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘After Apple Picking’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Frost’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- world-weariness in the given poem
- the difficult life of the woman in ‘The Black Cottage’
- the speaker’s attitude towards the boy’s death in ‘Out, Out – ’
- a variety of other feelings: eg in ‘Birches’, ‘An Unstamped Letter in Our Rural Letter Box’, ‘On Looking Up by Chance at the Constellations’
- more than just unhappiness in reflections upon life
- the perception of beauty in the natural world.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrative structure of the given poem in which description leads to personal and philosophical reflections
- the individual first-person voice in the given poem and several others but also an impersonal voice in ‘Out, Out – ’
- tone and mood in the attitude towards the reader and the speaker’s reflections
- the use of speech rhythms
- stanza form, the structural use of rhyme and other features of prosody
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

1	0
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Seamus Heaney poetry selection

‘Political problems are the most important feature of Heaney’s poetry.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Heaney's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the bog poems and how these reflect the violence of ‘The Troubles’
- the history of oppression : eg as in ‘Requiem for the Croppies’, ‘Act of Union’, ‘The Toome Road’
- the poet’s sense of being obliged to address the political situation as he finds it: eg ‘North’, ‘Punishment’
- political concerns being secondary in relation to culture or in responses to places
- personal poems that are apolitical: eg ‘Mid-term Break’, ‘Anahorish’, ‘A New Song’
- poetic inspiration: eg ‘Personal Helicon’, ‘The Peninsula’.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- aspects of structure: eg the three sections of ‘The Tollund Man’ with description, then political response and a conclusion; history followed by response in ‘North’
- voice and/or point of view: eg a Croppy speaking from his grave, first person observer in ‘Punishment’ and oppressor in ‘Act of Union’
- tone in attitude towards subject matter and/or reader
- lexical choices and figurative language to evoke milieus
- patterns of rhyme and half-rhyme and other features of prosody
- structural use of stanza form: eg quatrains, and two-sonnet form of ‘Act of Union’.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.